

Activity Type

Writing, listening and speaking activity, group work

Language Focus

Coordinating and subordinating conjunctions

Aim

To invent and tell a story using coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

Preparation

Make one copy of the story title cards and conjunction cards for each group of four and cut as indicated. Keep the two sets of cards separate.

Level

Intermediate

Time

45 minutes

Introduction

In this creative teaching activity, students invent and tell a story using coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

Procedure

Divide the students into groups of four.

Elicit types of stories and write the students' ideas on the board, e.g. science fiction, mystery, adventure, etc.

Give each group a set of story title cards. Ask the students to spread the cards out face up on the table.

Tell the students to make three story titles using the words on the cards, e.g. 'The Dark Winter', etc.

Ask the groups to read their titles to the class and elicit the type of story for each one, e.g. a fantasy story.

Explain that the groups are going to choose one of their titles and develop it into a story by creating sentences with coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

Give each group a piece of paper and ask them to write the title and first line of their story on the paper. For example, if the title was 'The Dark Winter', students might write: Mary ran out of the house into the snow.

Next, give each group a set of conjunction cards. Ask the students to shuffle the cards and place them face down in a pile on the table.

Students then take it in turns to pick up a card from the top of the pile and use the conjunction on the card in the next sentence of the story, e.g. 'This was Mary's last chance to collect firewood before winter set in'.

As a student says the next sentence, another student in the group writes it down on the paper.

This continues until all the cards have been used.

When the groups have finished, ask them to review their story and check for any errors.

The groups then take it in turns to tell their story to the class.

After each group has told their story, give feedback on their use of conjunctions.

Finally, have the class vote for the best story.

Note: This is an editable PDF. To edit the document, select the Edit PDF tool in Acrobat.

Story title cards

adventure

world

little

lost

the

trail

of

island

life

summer

story

star

planet

for

Texas

ghost

space

law

hotel

the

girl

heart

in

time

winter

night

man

house

earth

boy

of

day

love

dark

wild

the

Conjunction cards


before	because	that	and
nor	and	even if	than
although	unless	rather than	whether
once	but	for	as
while	after	why	during
but	until	as soon as	if
even though	so that	so	or
where	yet	since	just as
so	by the time	though	when